

Ἡδυλη

Scylla and Galatea in the Hexameter Fragments of Hedyle

eul_aid: kgy

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Ἀττική [Attic](#)

Domain: Ποίησις [Poetry](#)

Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Hedyle was a Hellenistic poet active in the 4th–3rd century BCE. She was the daughter of the poetess Hedylus and the mother of the epigrammatist Hedylus. According to the Suda, she was from Athens, though some sources claim Samos.

Her only known work is the lost hexameter poem Scylla. A two-line fragment preserved by Athenaeus describes the mythical monster with the upper body of a beautiful maiden.

Hedyle is a minor but attested figure, significant as one of the few named Greek women poets from the period. Her existence demonstrates women's participation in Hellenistic literary culture, and her poem represents an early interest in mythological and erotic narrative later explored by poets like Parthenius. Her primary historical importance lies within her familial literary dynasty, connecting the poets Hedylus, her mother, and Hedylus, her son.

Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Σκύλλης καὶ Γαλατείας · [Fragments on Scylla and Galatea](#) · 3 passages